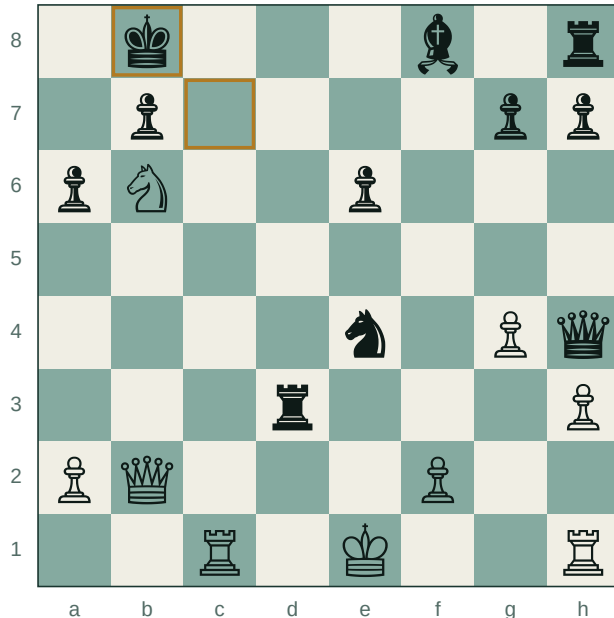


# Queenside attacks: White, move 21

Queenside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 20...Kb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**21. Rc8+ Ka7 22. Ra8#**

**21.Rc8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c8 it attacks king on b8 and bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **21...Ka7**.

**22.Ra8#** Mate: rook on a8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on a8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An attack on the queenside can target a castled king, a vulnerable pawn, or trapped pieces. Files and entry squares matter more than simply advancing flank pawns.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

The defending king is on b8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and queen on h4. Check for tactical protection.